

GenAI Tool Tracker

A quick-reference guide organized by generation modality. Updated regularly but the world of AI advances quicker than we can update these sources so some things may be outdated.

1. Text Generation (LLMs)

Tool	Best For	Free Tier (General Capabilities)	Paid Tier (General Capabilities)
ChatGPT (OpenAI) <Chatgpt.com>	Writing, reasoning, multimodal chat	• Access to a lightweight model • Shorter context window • Slower responses • Limited file/image analysis • Basic reasoning and coding	• Access to frontier models • Long context window • Faster responses + higher rate limits • Reliable file/image/audio analysis • Strong reasoning & coding performance
Claude (Anthropic) <Claude.ai>	Careful reasoning, long documents	• Smaller model • Short-to-medium context • Limited uploads	• High-accuracy model • Very long context window • Large uploads (PDFs, docs) • Strong analytical &

		• Moderate reasoning reliability	structured writing abilities
Gemini (Google) <gemini.google.com>	Web-integrated reasoning, multimodal	• Lightweight model • Basic multimodal features • Basic browsing-style results • Slower, less accurate reasoning	• Advanced model • Long context & faster performance • Strong multimodal understanding • Better factual accuracy & reasoning
Perplexity <perplexity.ai>	Research-style answers w/ citations	• Free research mode • Limited depth of citations • Uses smaller models • Basic web access	• Access to premium models (GPT, Claude) • Deeper synthesis + better citations • Faster & more consistent outputs
Copilot (Microsoft) <copilot.microsoft.com>	Coding + Office tools	• Basic chat + lightweight model • Limited coding suggestions • No Office integration	• Advanced reasoning model • Integrated into Word/Excel/PowerPoint • Strong coding + debugging support

Lmarena <lmarena.ai>	Free, limited comparison between models	Basic interactions with many different models	N/A
Notebooklm < https://notebooklm.google.com/ >	RAG based chat, audio generation, video, etc.	50 sources. Limited generations	More sources, faster generation. (Free tier is sufficient for many applications)

Notes:

- **Free tiers = smaller models, shorter memories, limited uploads, slower speeds.**
- **Paid tiers = better reasoning, longer documents, richer multimodal abilities, and higher reliability.**
- These patterns apply across **all** major tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, Copilot).

2. Image Generation

Tool	Best For	Free Tier	Paid Tier
DALL-E < https://openai.com/index/dall-e-2/ >	Photorealistic images, design	Limited credits	More generations, HD
Midjourney < https://www.midjourney.com/home >	Stylized artistic images	None	Subscription
Stable Diffusion / SDXL / SD3	Local/offline generation, open source	Fully free if local. Sites like	Paid GPU hosting.

		<openart.ai > offer free trials.	
Frontier models (chatGPT, gemini)	General image generation	Some, limited	More iterations, high limits
Adobe Firefly	Photoshop/Illustrator workflows	Limited credits	HD + commercial rights

3. Audio Generation (Speech, Voice, Music)

Tool	Best For	Free Tier	Paid Tier
ElevenLabs < https://elevenlabs.io/ >	Voice cloning, narration	Limited characters	High-quality cloning + long outputs
Suno <suno.com>	Music + vocals from prompts	Free daily credits	Higher quality + longer tracks
AudioCraft / MusicGen < https://audiocraft.metademolab.com/ >	Open-source music generation	Free local	—

4. Video Generation & Editing

Tool	Best For	Free Tier	Paid Tier
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Runway < https://runwayml.com/ >	Text-to-video, motion style	Low-res	HD + fast rendering
Pika Labs < pika.art >	Short stylized video	Low-res	HD
Luma Dream Machine < lumalabs.ai >	Cinematic realism	Limited runs	HD + priority
Synthesia < synthesia.io >	Talking-head avatars	Limited	Full avatar library
Sora (openAI)	High quality, short video clips	Limited	More generations, longer clips

5. Code Generation

Tool	Best For	Free Tier	Paid Tier
GitHub Copilot < https://github.com/copilot >	Code completion, debugging	Trial. Limited interactions per month	Subscription
Replit Ghostwriter < replit.com >	Beginner-friendly coding	Limited	Full IDE integration
ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini	Code explanation + debugging	Free models	Better reasoning + long context

6. Multimodal Models (Text + Image + Audio)

Tool	Notes
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ChatGPT	Unified multimodal input/output
Gemini	Massive context window
Claude	Strong long-context reasoning

7. Open-Source Models

Model	Notes
LLaMA	Strong general-purpose models
Mistral / Mixtral	Efficient, high-quality small models
Stable Diffusion (SDXL, SD3)	Open image generation
Whisper	Free speech-to-text transcription

8. Other helpful resources

Resource	Notes
Futuretools.io	A large, regularly updated directory of AI tools across many categories (text, image, audio, productivity, research, etc.). Helpful for discovering new tools, comparing capabilities, and staying current with the quickly changing GenAI ecosystem.
Lmarena <lmarena.ai>	A public leaderboard and “battle arena” where you can compare top AI models side-by-side without knowing which model you're testing. Great for observing differences in reasoning, tone, accuracy, and creativity

	across the most capable frontier and open-source models. “Battle mode” is default, Select ‘Direct Chat’ to choose a model.
Huggingface <huggingface.co> and <huggingface.co/chat>	A central hub for open-source AI models, datasets, and demos. You can try models directly in the browser, explore how they’re trained, download them for local use, or examine model cards to understand limitations, capabilities, and licensing. Excellent for transparency and experimentation.